THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

PARIS BRANCH

JULY 2013 NEWSLETTER

Chairman's Report

- "Easy Oar !!", as we used to hear the Cox bellow in an Eight at School. It's the time of year when, if you are lucky, you can begin to wind down a little, with the summer holidays just round the corner. Having said that the RBL Year is not yet over and a number of events are featured in the Section "For Your Diary" below. So I do encourage members to show their support and appreciation of the hard-working Event Organizers by turning out.
- On your behalf I want to thank Janet Warby and Joan Hicks for their superb organization of the Coronation Anniversary Cocktail at the Ecole Militaire. To attract over 200 guests on a Friday evening in Summer was no mean achievement. Bravo indeed. As Sir Peter Ricketts said, in his address leading to the Loyal Toast, they even managed to provide some decent weather. Fortune favours the brave. Thanks to Andrew Holford and his brilliant music-makers, and to Jon Cooper our Toast-Master in splendid hunting pink.
- The Coronation Anniversary theme is picked up by Gerald Jory in his fascinating account attached of the massive military contribution to that iconic event in 1953. As we watch those black and white television images of the Procession to the Abbey and back to Buckingham Palace it is hard to appreciate the extent of the presence on that day of the armed forces of Britain and the Commonwealth. Gerald said that he played his own small part in that military contribution, hence his encyclopaedic knowledge of the detail. Thank you so much Gerald.
- May I draw your attention to the Talk by Branch member Edouard Plunkett in the Clubhouse on 16th July, entitled "The British Soldier in Afghanistan" (Flyer attached). Edouard, who served in Iraq and Afghanistan, has often given this presentation to British units just before their departure for Afghanistan. When the Royal Fusilier was murdered outside his barracks in Greenwich recently I was touched by the remark made by a French TV commentator, when he referred to the outrage felt by the British public, who "hold their armed forces in great respect". Rightly so.
- Don't forget one of our landmark events, the Ravivage de La Flamme sous L'Arc de Triomphe" on 4th August. This has been our privilege every year on that date since 1924, with the exception of the years 1940-43. This year it is the turn of the New Zealanders to rekindle the Flame, the Dominion with the highest casualty rate as a percentage of their population.
- We hope you enjoy your Summer break.

"We will remember them"

FOR YOUR DIARY

16th July: 7pm "The British Soldier in Afghanistan" Talk by Edouard Plunkett (Flyer attached).
18th July: 12.30 for 1pm. Club Lunch in the Clubhouse. Reservations @16€ to Joan Hicks.
4th August: 6.15 for 6.30pm. Ravivage de la Flamme sous l'Arc de Triomphe + Reception at 7.30pm in Clubhouse.
8th September: 3pm. "Pedal to Paris". Cyclists arrive at the Arc de Triomphe + Wreath-laying.
4th-6th October: Battlefield Visit to Dunkirk with Colonel Oliver Warman. (Details to follow).